

PEGASUS

Midterm Report

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Outline

- Project Outline and Goals
- Current Progress
 - Gantt Chart
- Proposed Reformer Operation
 - Schematics
 - 3-D Representation
- Reformation - Methanol Fuel
- Alternate Fuels
- Current Technology and Applications
- Future Operations

Project Goals

- Design and Construct a prototype
- Explain in detail the operation with visual aids
 - Onboard Fuel Reformer prototype
 - Schematics
 - Video clips

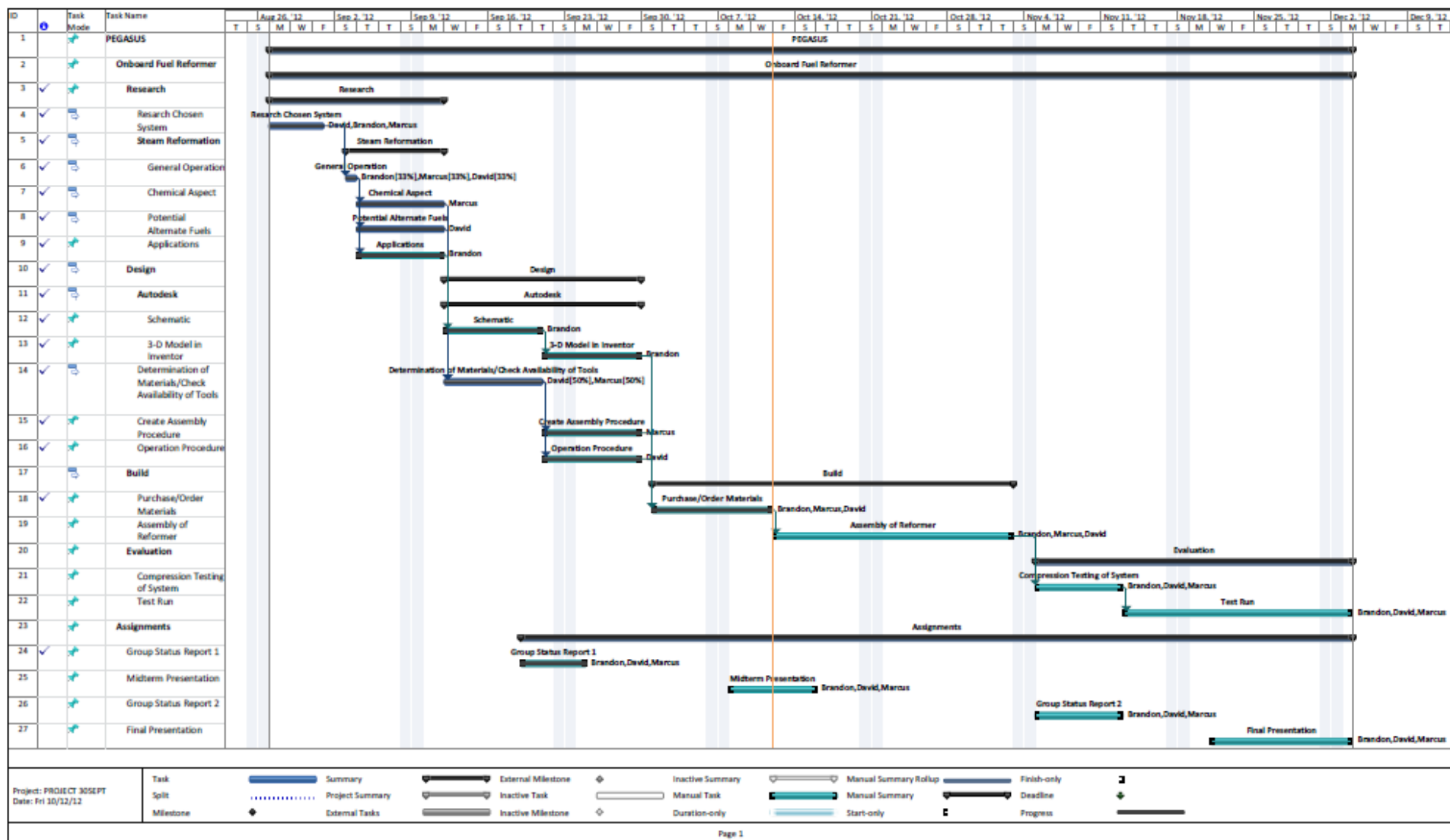
Project Overview

- The main purpose of this device is to take a fuel, increase that fuel's efficiency, and significantly reduce emissions
- Secondary purpose is to be able to run on a wide variety of fuels, both petroleum and non-petroleum products
- Compact and suitable for many different sized applications

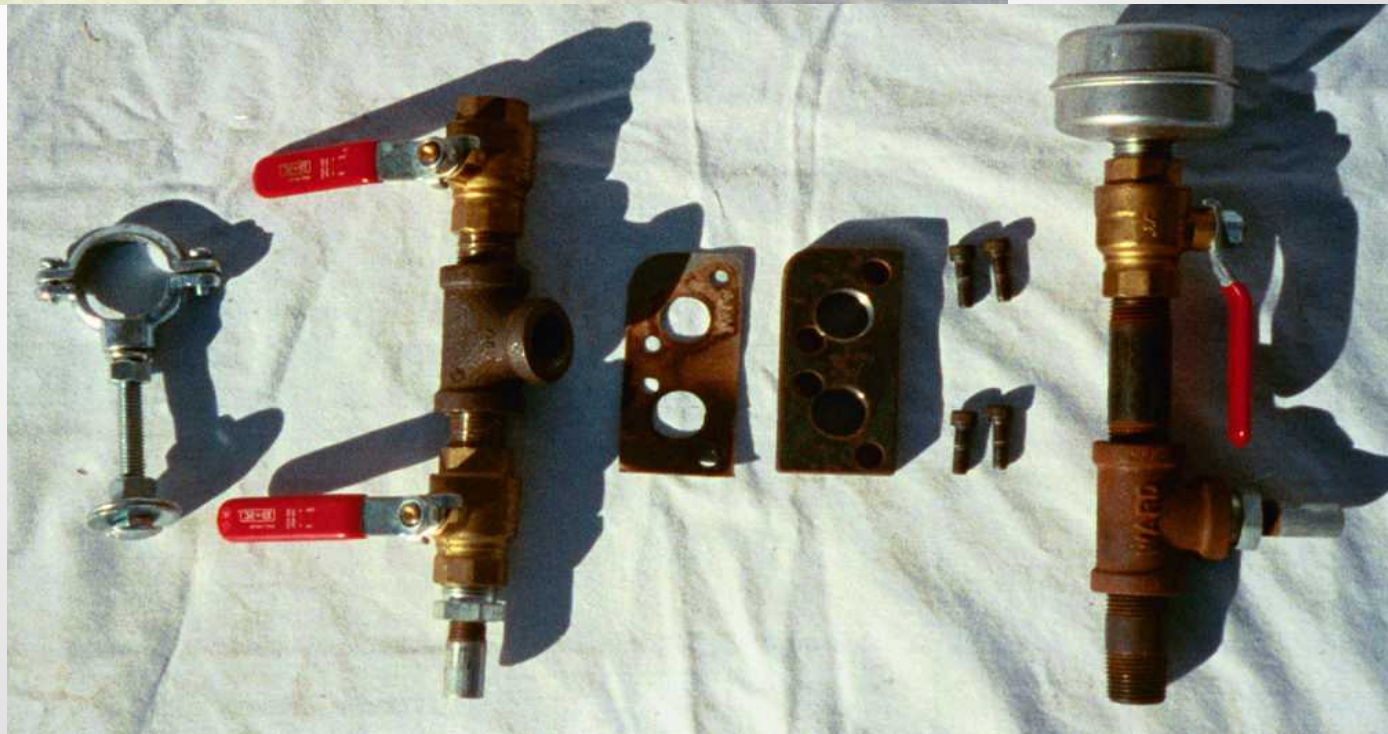
Current Tasks

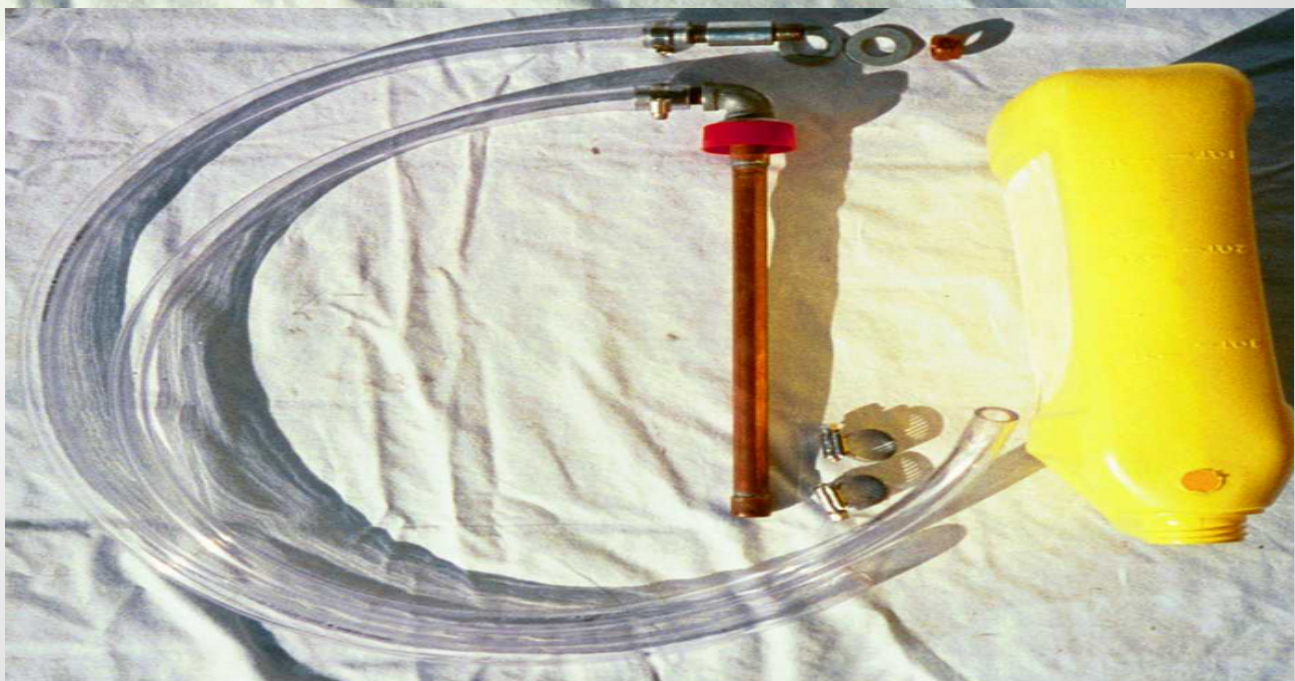
- Reformer Assembly
 - Machining of parts
 - Welding/soldering joints
 - Revision of parts lists
- Updating of Assembly Procedure
 - Fine tuning procedure as changes occur
- Updating of Schematics
 - Sizes and connections may change as design is modified

GANTT Chart

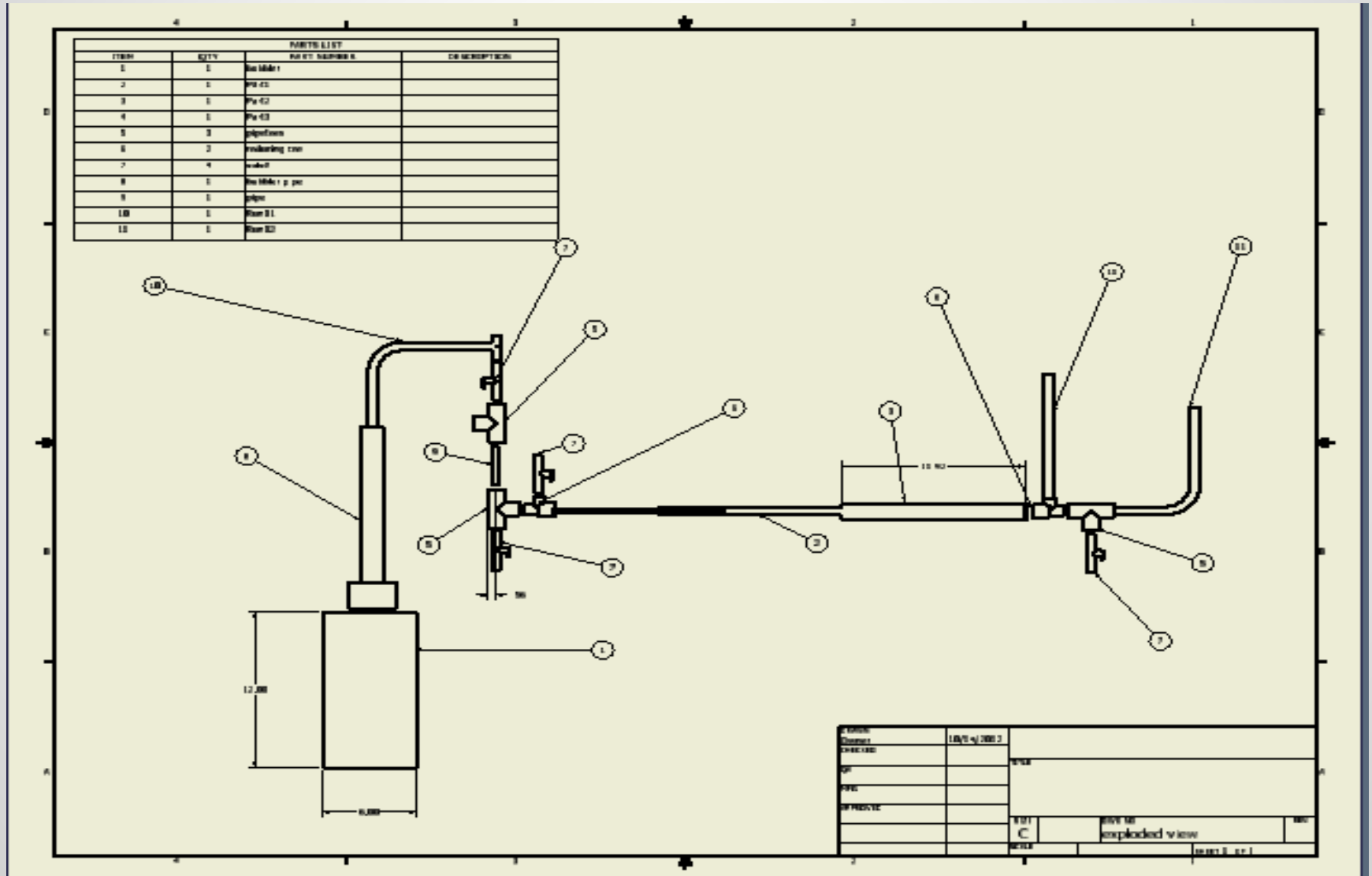


On-board Fuel Reformer

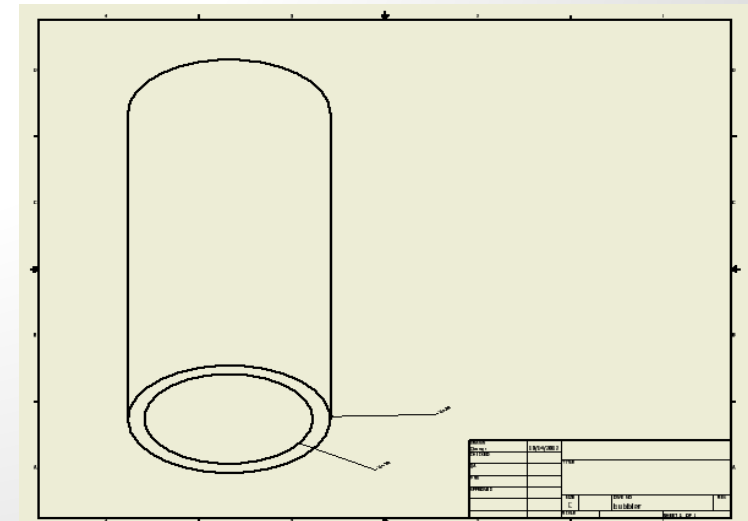
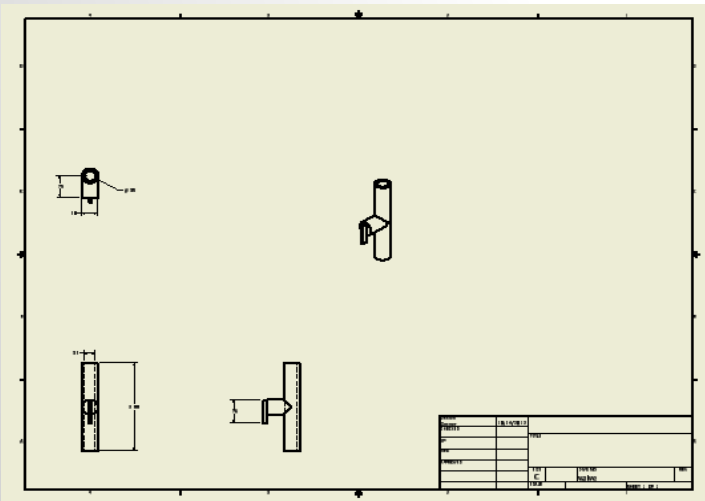
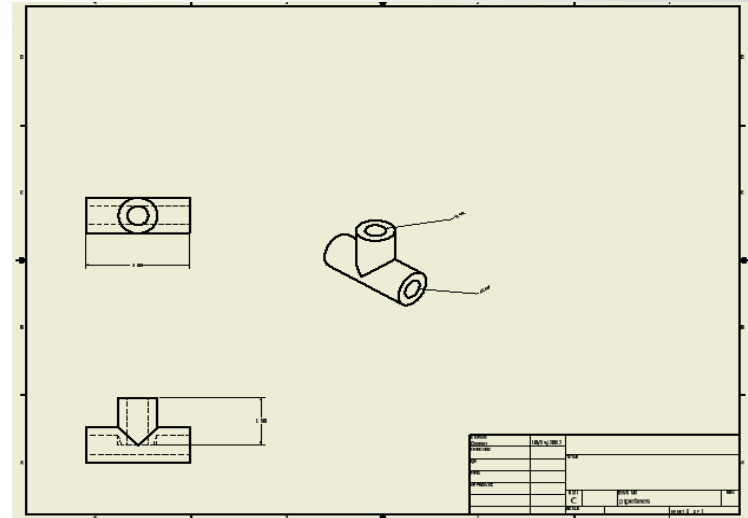
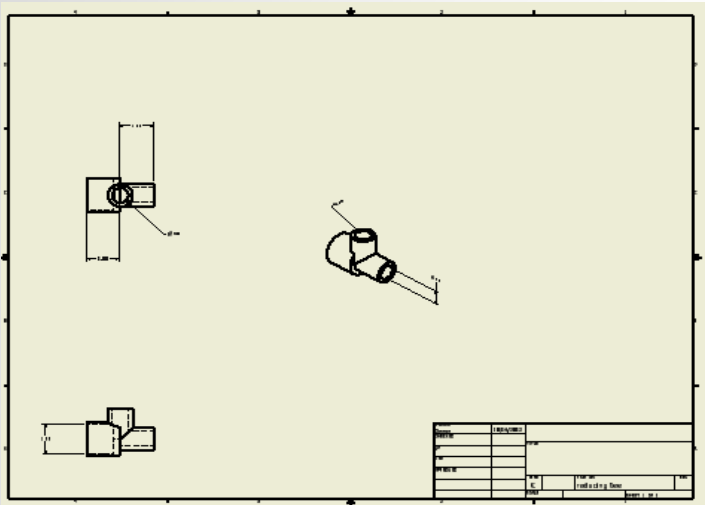




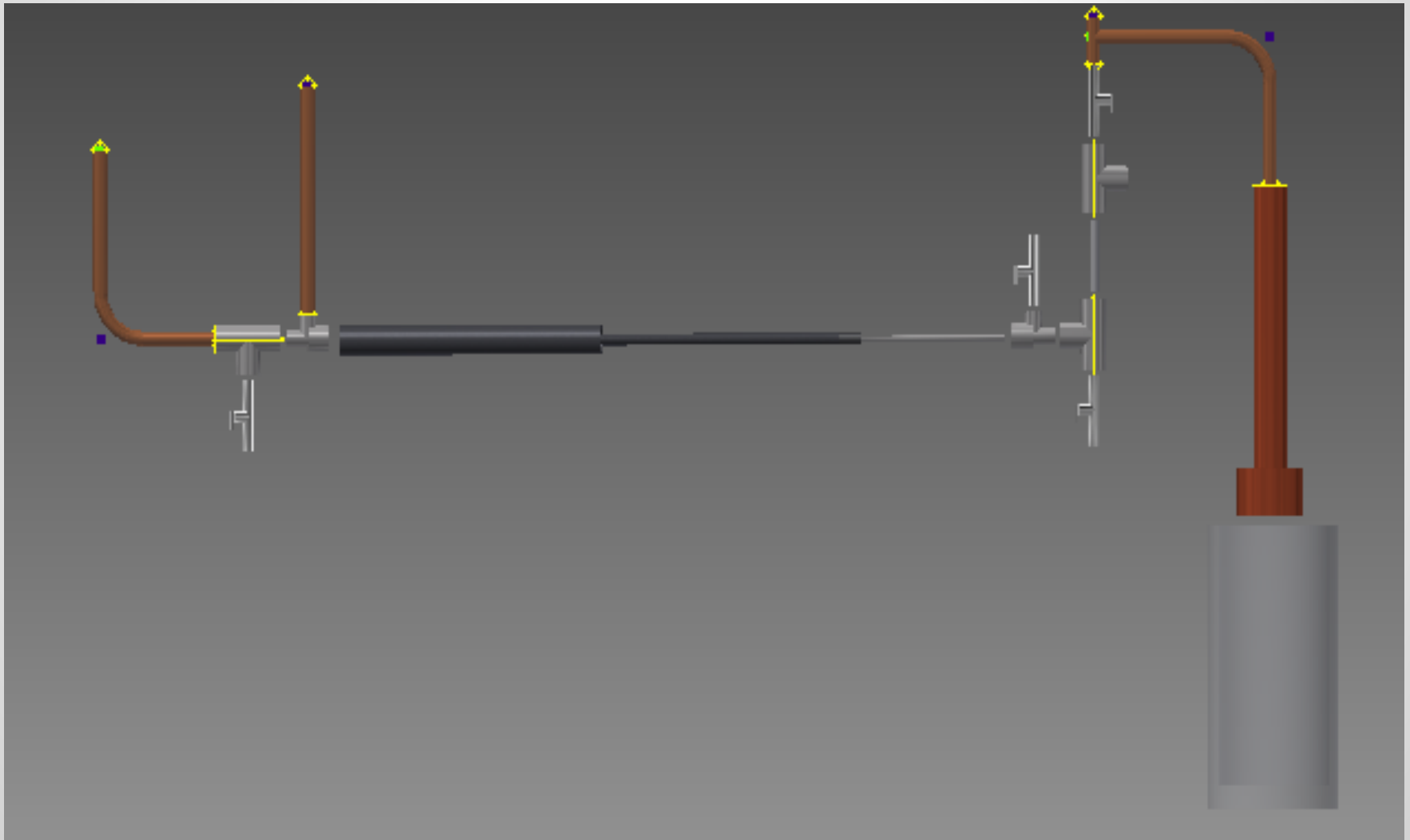
Schematics



Select Parts



3-D Model

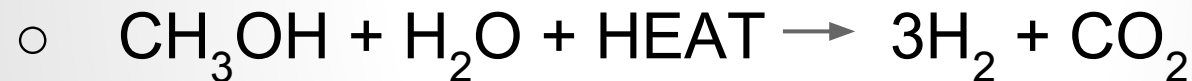


Chemical Aspects

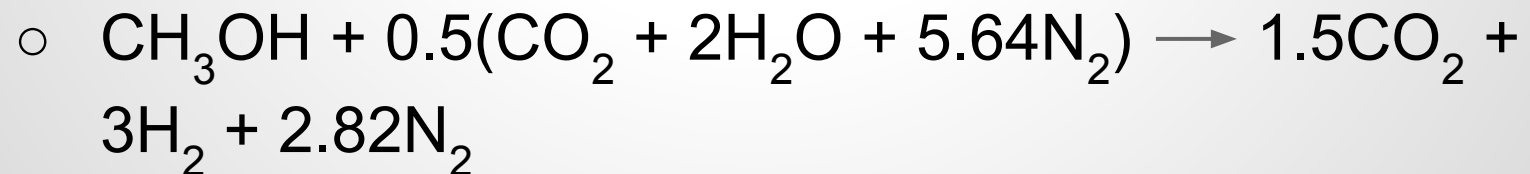
- Combustion of methanol



- Steam Reformation



- Reformation using exhaust



Research: Alternate Fuels

- ***Alternate fuels:***

- Methanol
- Ethanol
- Liquor
- Paint Thinner
- Spent Motor Oil/Transmission fluid
- Bio-fuels
 - Trans-esterification
- Water (increases efficiency with more water added to the system, up to a threshold)

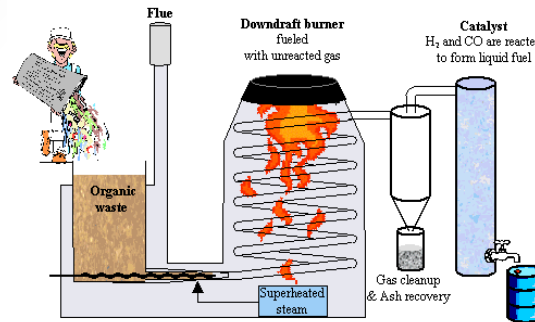
- Any liquid containing hydrogen is able to be reformed

Applications/Current Research

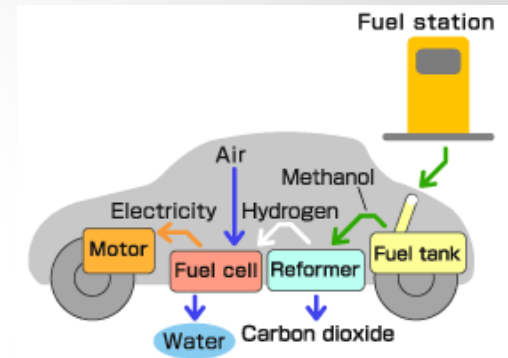
Plasmatron M.I.T.



Organic Fuel Reformer



On-Board Methanol



Autothermal Reformer



"If widespread use of plasmatron hydrogen-enhanced gasoline engines could eventually increase the average efficiency of cars and other light-duty vehicles by 20 percent, the amount of gasoline that could be saved would be around 25 billion gallons a year," Cohn said. "That corresponds to around 70 percent of the oil that is currently imported by the United States from the Middle East."

Future Tasks through Final Presentation

- Assembly of the Reformer
- Attach Device to Lawnmower
- Establish Safety Protocol
- Begin Testing Phase with Different Fuels
- Adjustments and Modify

Questions?